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Sankat Mochan Hanuman Temple

The **Sankat Mochan Hanuman Temple** is a Hindu temple in Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh, India dedicated to the Hindu deity Hanuman, in his form as *sankat mochan* (*saṅkaṭamocana*), meaning the "reliever from troubles".[1] The temple was established by the Hindu preacher and poet-saint Tulsidas in the early 16th century. It is situated on the banks of the Assi river.

Sankat Mochan Hanuman Temple

संकट मोचन हनुमान मंदिर

The entrance to Sankat Mochan Hanuman Temple

Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
Deity	Hanuman, Rama
Location	
Location	Varanasi
State	Uttar Pradesh
Country	India

Temple location on Varanasi district map

History

It is believed that the temple built on the very spot where Tulsidas had a vision of Hanuman.[2] It was founded by Tulsidas who was the author of the *Ramacharitamanasa*. Tradition promises that regular visitors to the temple will gain the special favor of Hanuman. Every Tuesday and Saturday thousands of people queue up in front of the temple to offer prayers to Hanuman. According to Vedic Astrology, Hanuman saves human beings from the anger of the planet Shani (Saturn), and especially people who have an ill-placed Saturn in their horoscopes visit this temple for astrological remedies. This is supposed to be the most effective way for appeasing Shani. Some astrologers believe that worshiping Hanuman can neutralize the ill-effect of Mangala (Mars) and practically any planet that has an ill effect on human life. It is believed that Tulsidas is believed to have written most of the verses of *Ramacharitamanasa* in this temple.[3]

Terrorist incident

On 7 March 2006, one of three explosions hit the temple while the aarti was in progress in which numerous worshippers and wedding attendees were participating. The crowd helped each other in the rescue operation after the explosion. The next day a large number of devotees resumed their worship as usual.[4]

Coordinates	25.2821062°N 82.9999769°E
Architecture	
Type	Hindu architecture
Creator	Tulsidas
Completed	16th century

Temple today

The temple still continues to be attended by thousands of Rama and Hanuman devotees who chant Hanuman Chalisa and Sundarkand (also provided in the form of a booklet in the temple for free). After the terrorist incident of 2006, a permanent police post was set up inside the temple.[5]

Sankat Mochan Foundation

The Sankat Mochan Foundation (SMF) was established in 1982 by Veer Bhadra Mishra, the Mahant (High priest) of the temple, and has been working for cleaning and protecting the Ganges river. Its projects are funded in part by aid from the U. S. and Swedish governments. Mishra was formerly former Head of the Civil Engineering Department at the Indian Institute of Technology (BHU) Varanasi [IIT(BHU)][6] and was awarded United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) established the "Global 500 Roll of Honour" in 1992,[7] and later the *TIME* magazine's "Hero of the Planet" award in 1999.[8][9]

The foundation has been working with Australia-based environmental group, Oz Greene, under a programme called "Swatcha Ganga Abhiyan" for over 25 years. It celebrated its silver jubilee on 3–4 November 2007, with two-day event which concluded at the Tulsi Ghat, on the Ganges.[10]

Sankat Mochan Sangeet Samaroh

Each year in the month of April, the temple organizes a classical music and dance concert festival titled "Sankat Mochan Sangeet Samaroh", in which musicians and performers from all over India take part. The first festival was organized 88 years ago, and it has invited musicians and dancers including Odissi guru Kelucharan Mahapatra, who was associated since its early days. In fact he was instrumental in starting women's participation in the festival with Sanjukta Panigrahi, Swapna Sundari and Kankana Banerjee.[11]

In 2009, the six-day concert saw over 35 artists including, vocalist Jasraj and Kathak exponent Birju Maharaj.[12][13]

The 2010 concert was spread over five days, during which artists such as Jasraj, Sunanda Patnaik, Channulal Mishra, Rajan-Sajan Mishra and Amar Nath Mishra performed.[14]

In 2015 concert Pakistani-ghazal singer Ghulam Ali performed at Sankat Mochan Sangeet Samaroh.[15][16][17]

See also

- Sankat Mochan Temple, Shimla
- Hindu temples in Varanasi

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External links

- Web India - Places of interest in Varanasi (http://www.webindia123.com/city/up/varanasi/attra.htm?cat=Places%20of%20Interest)
- Sankat Mochan Foundation, Official website (http://www.sankatmochanfoundationonline.org)
- BBC - High priest horrified by blast (http://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/south_asia/4783646.stm) *BBC News*

Images

- Image of the main gate of temple (http://vayusutha.in/vs4/sankatamochan.jpg)
- interior view (https://web.archive.org/web/20110717184839/http://www.varanasi-hotels.com/sankatmochan.jpg)

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